desperate people, and that he as the commander had to enrapture, raise morale, and find a way out of the muddle.

This was Kokla. We loved him, we trusted him, and sometimes we were angry with him. His professional contribution to the two operational units in which he served, one of which he commanded, proved to be groundbreaking. And so we will remember him.

Dave Kimche (March 10, 2010)

The ultimate intelligence man has left us.

Born and educated in England, Dave pursued Middle Eastern studies in Israel, right up to and including a doctorate. The wonderful combination of these achievements, skills, and abilities created a multilingual man with extensive and profound experience in a number of Western cultures, along with his entrenched Israeliness, with the virtues and shortcomings that go along with that. He was an intellectual with a formal education and a deep understanding of the world in general and the Middle East and Africa in particular.

His immigration to Israel at the age of eighteen was out of Zionist motivations, and his affinity with Israel was immediate, absolute, and uncompromising; he shed all signs of his past affinities and later reintroduced them as tools with which to serve the State of Israel and its people. Dave was an amiable and gregarious man, and very brave, “a British gentleman,” comfortable in the intellectual environment of “understatement” and “cautious optimism.” With such a toolbox there wasn’t an intelligence role that Dave could not fulfill with the proficiency of a virtuoso.

Dave started his intelligence career in the Mossad on the “aircraft carrier” of intelligence—HUMINT. In this profession, he learned how to get to know the enemy by the “whites of their eyes.” With his ability to borrow identities, connect with people, and smooth-talk, he succeeded expertly in leading the source through the entire path of recruitment, from the establishment of contact, through the stage of “corruption,” to the referral to the recruiter (usually for a foreign intelligence service) to operation, intelligence interrogation, and briefings—the production of intelligence. Dave’s comprehensive operational abilities enabled him to deal successfully